

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: John experiences the Day of the Dead.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about travel and vacations in social situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know any other cultures that honor the dead?
- What do they do to honor the dead?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about what people did or were.
- I can express opinions about other people and things.
- I can write a short travel journal.





Let's Explore!

John writes a short travel **journal*** about the Day of the Dead.

* When you write a travel "journal", think about what you might want to remember from the trip in 10, 20, or even 30 years.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The Day of the Dead festival was an interesting cultural experience. I thought it would be a sad day but I was wrong. Mexican families remembered their loved ones by telling stories and having picnics in cemeteries.

Family members cleaned the graves of the dead and left trinkets or candles. I believe it was a wonderful insight into the lives of others. You could hear the soft sound of music while people shared meals with family members and neighbors.

Some families took part in craft activities and musical performances. Traditional music played in the streets. People prayed in churches and in their homes. They also shared photos of the deceased and talked to them. It was a touching tribute to their loved ones.



Let's Practice!

What do you include in a short travel journal? Do you have any *tips?

*If you do not have time to write a lot of information, use notes that you can turn into sentences later.

Instructions: Choose all the correct answers.

1. What do you include in a short travel journal?

- a. Your itinerary
- b. Your homework
- c. Names of people you met
- d. Sights, smells and tastes
- e. Photos or drawings
- f. A shopping list

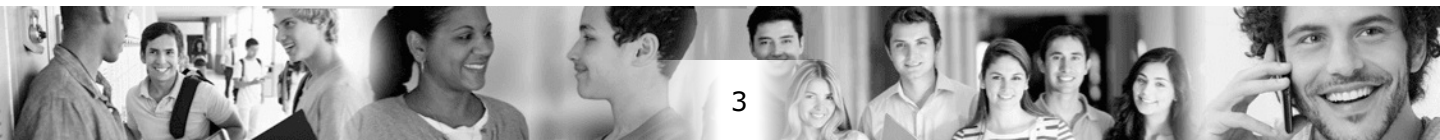


Let's Practice!

What is your opinion?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the blank with the missing word. Use: insight, thought, was, cleaned, deceased, touching.

1. They also shared photos of the _____ and talked to them.
2. It was a _____ tribute to their loved ones.
3. I _____ it would be a sad day but I was wrong.
4. I believe it was a wonderful _____ into the lives of others.
5. Family members _____ the graves of the dead and left trinkets or candles.
6. The Day of the Dead festival _____ an interesting cultural experience.





Extension Activity

It's time for you to write your opinion on a festival or tradition.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research an interesting festival or tradition.
- Write a paragraph of 50 words.
- Include a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence.
- Provide your opinion.
- Read your paragraph aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify an interesting festival or tradition.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph on a festival or tradition.

☐ ☐

I include my opinion on a festival or tradition.

☐ ☐

I read my paragraph to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **deceased** (noun): a dead person or dead people
e.g. People celebrate the deceased in some cultures.
- **tribute** (noun): something that you say, give, or do to show respect or affection for someone
e.g. It was a wonderful tribute to their grandfather.
- **touching** (adjective): having a strong emotional effect
e.g. It was touching to see the family come together.
- **loved one** (noun): a person who is loved, usually a family member
e.g. We honor our loved ones.
- **insight** (noun): the ability to understand situations and people clearly
e.g. The tradition gave me insight into their culture.
- **performance** (noun): an activity such as singing a song or acting in a play
e.g. The musical performance was excellent.





Learning Points

The Simple Past Tense

When you talk about events in the past, you usually use the Simple Past tense.

1. You use the Simple Past tense to talk about an action that happened **at a specific time in the past**.

Sally left for France on June 11th.
Peter visited his parents on Saturday.

2. You use the Simple Past tense to talk about **repeated** actions in the past.

Examples:
We went hiking every day in Grand Canyon.
Vanessa always went to the mall on Saturdays.

3. You use the Simple Past tense to talk about something that was **true for some length of time** in the past.

Examples:
John hated going to high school.
Sally played the violin when she was in school.

You often use phrases with **ago** with the Simple Past tense.

Example:
Sally and Vanessa met a long time ago.

